

## **Home Lab - Windows 11 Junk Files You Need to Delete Right Now**

### **Junk Files You Need to Delete Right Now**

Is your computer running slow?

Did you know that Windows has secret junk files you need to delete right now?

Here are the steps to delete them:

#### **Step 1: Prefetch Folder**

1. Spin up your Windows 11 VM in Oracle Virtual Box or VM Workstation Pro (You can do it on host machine too)
2. Click Windows + R which will take to you Run
3. Type prefetch then Enter. Windows will ask for an administrator permission.
3. Click Continue to go into a protected system folder.
4. Right click an empty area in the folder and click Properties. Observe the Size and Size on disk.
5. Press Control + A to select everything then Shift + Delete to skip the Recycle Bin entirely.

#### **Step 2: User Temp Folder**

1. Click Windows + R then type %temp% which will take you to the Temp folder.
2. Right click an empty area in the folder and click Properties.

You will see every installer that crashed half-way through, every update that failed and every app that closed unexpectedly. None of them cleaned up after themselves. All of it is still here, on a PC that hasn't been cleaned in a year or two. This folder alone can be holding gigabytes of files holding zero purpose.

3. Press Control + A to select everything then Shift + Delete to skip the Recycle Bin entirely. Skip any locked files.

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### Step 3: System Temp Folder

1. Click Windows + R then type %windir%\temp + Enter which will take you to the System Temp folder.

### Bonus Step: Flush DNS

1. Open the search bar and search for Command Prompt then right click it. Select Run as administrator
2. Type ipconfig /flushdns

You might see gigabytes flash before your eyes!

By the way, the old CCleaner did all these three steps with one click, before it became bloated spyware.

Question: How much did you remove?

### Keyboard Shortcuts:

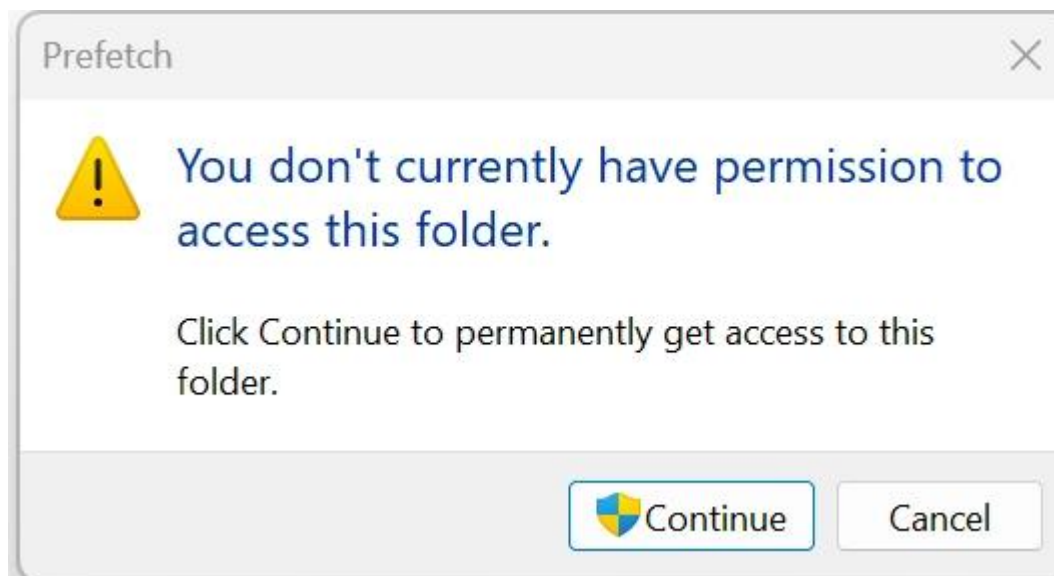
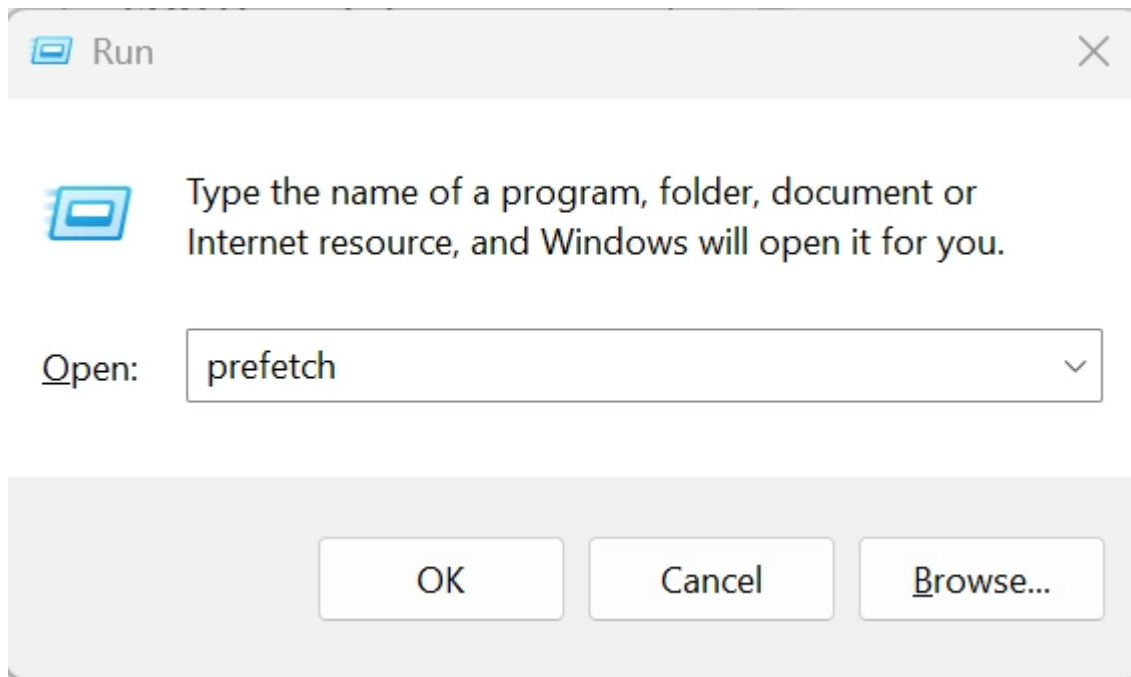
Ctrl + A → Select all files

Shift + Delete → Delete immediately (skips Recycle Bin)

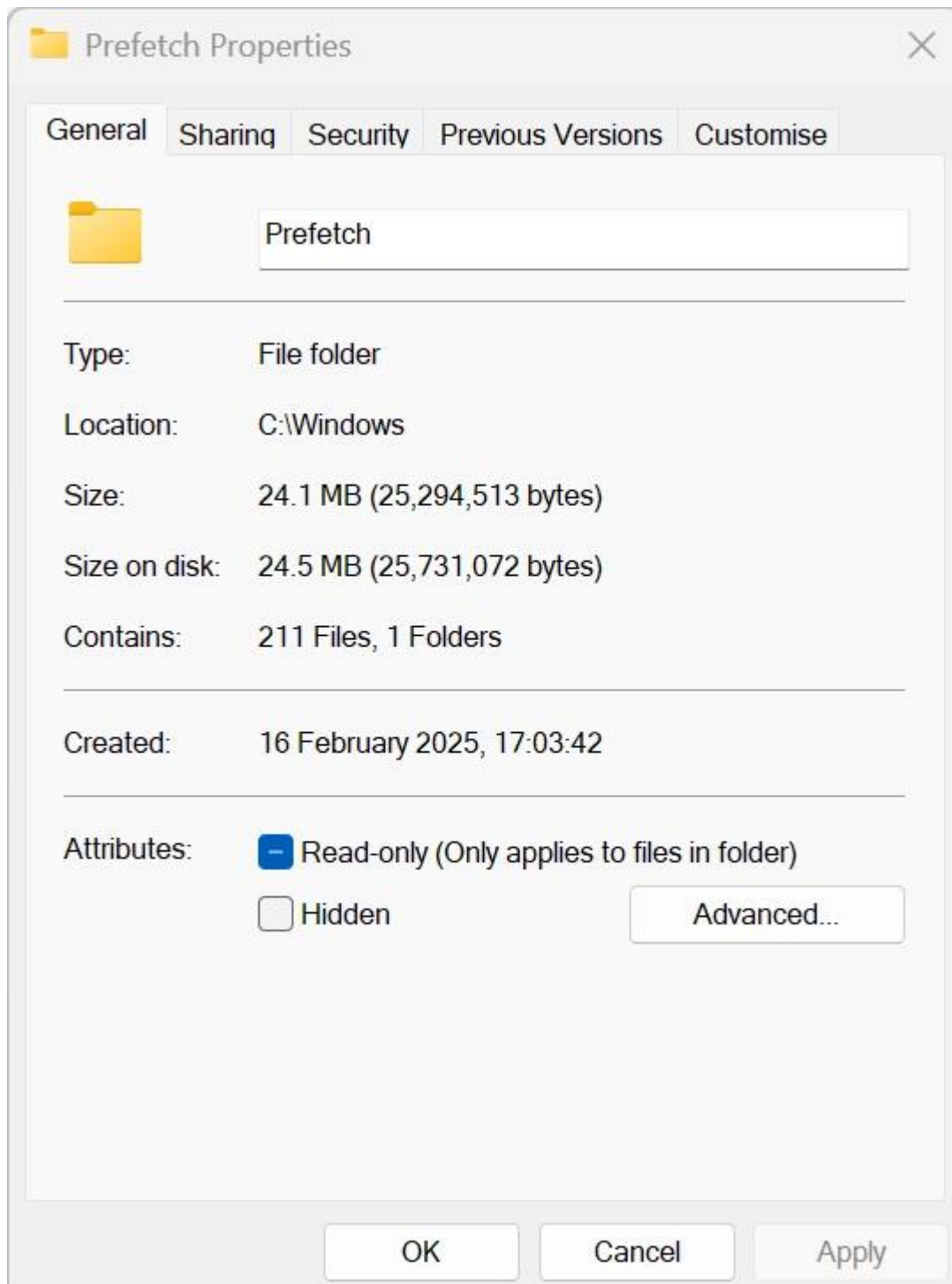
Skip → Any locked files - this is normal, leave them alone

### Screenshots:

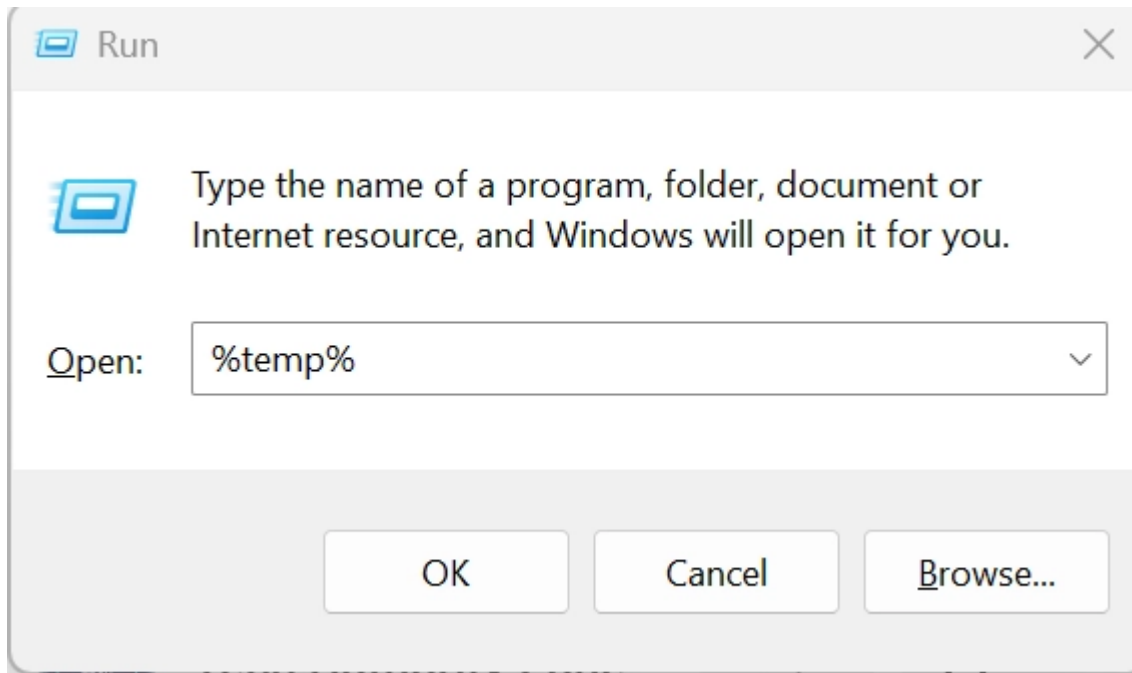
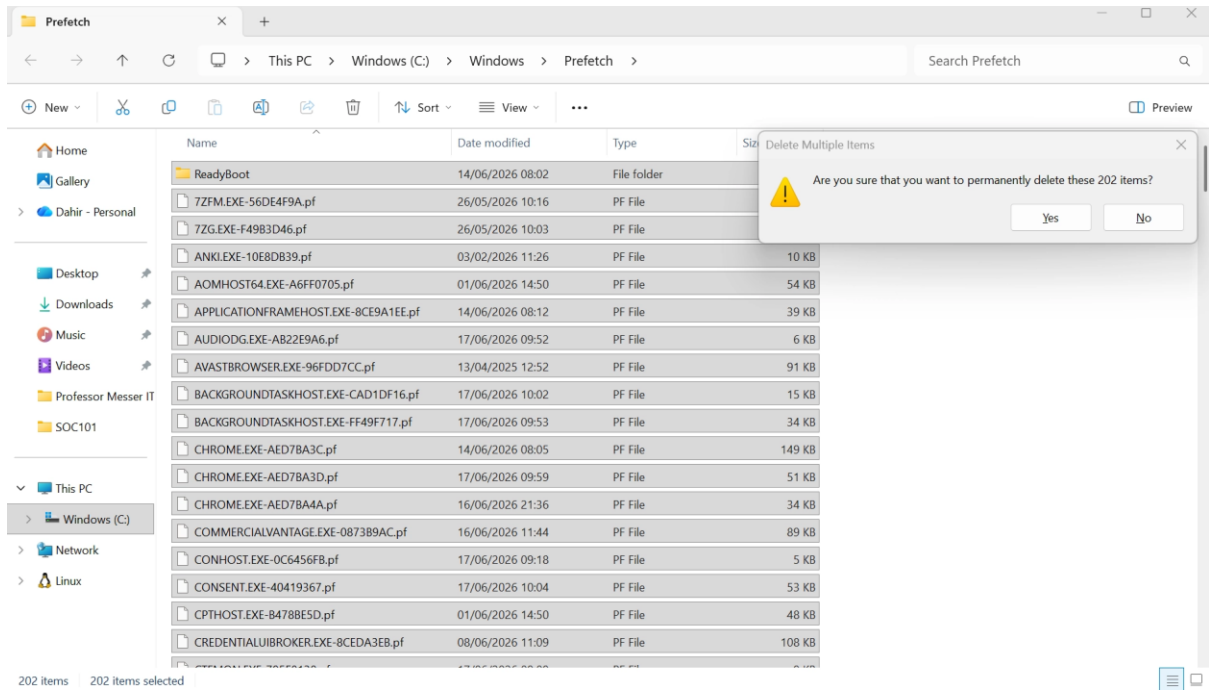
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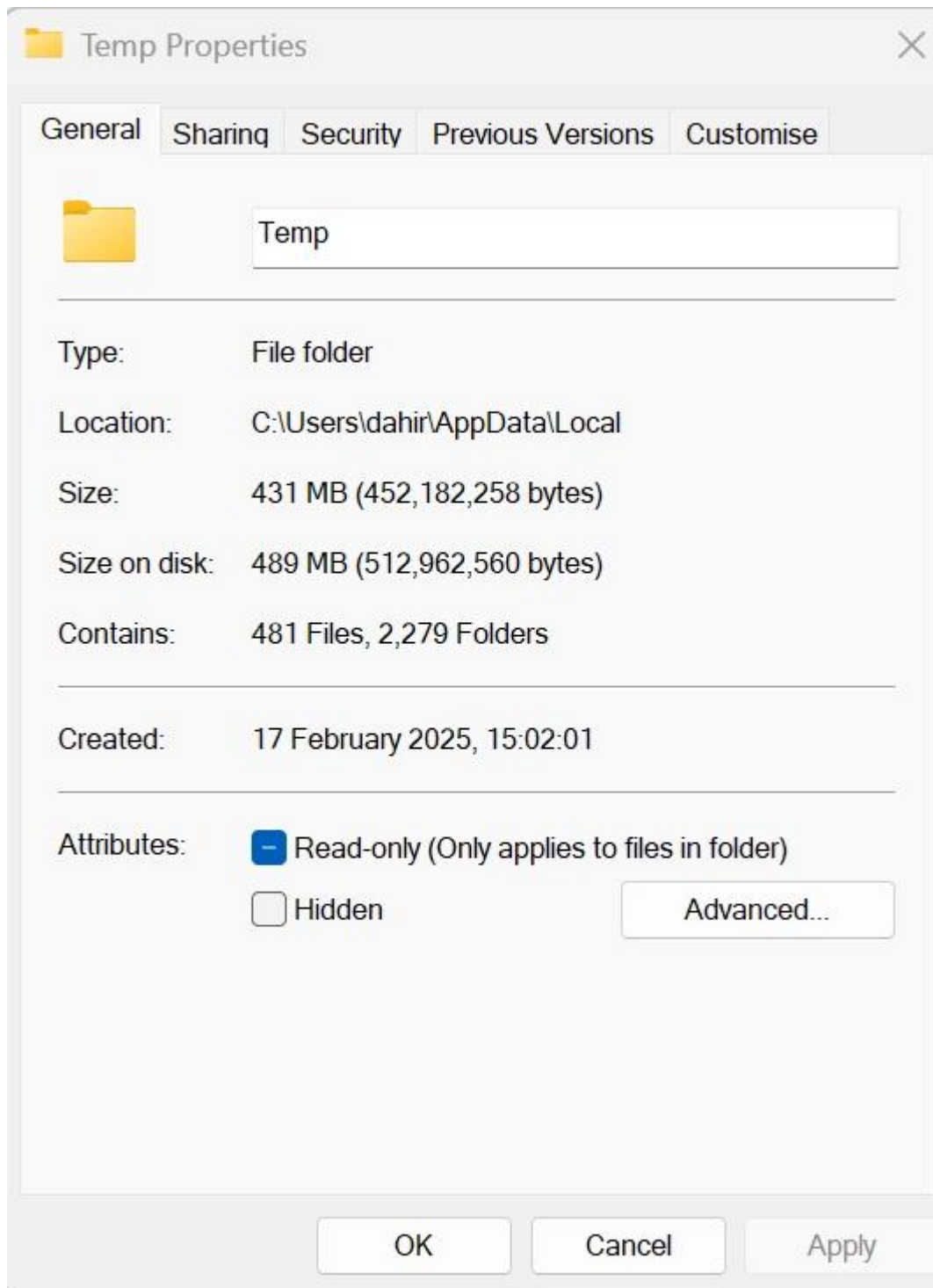
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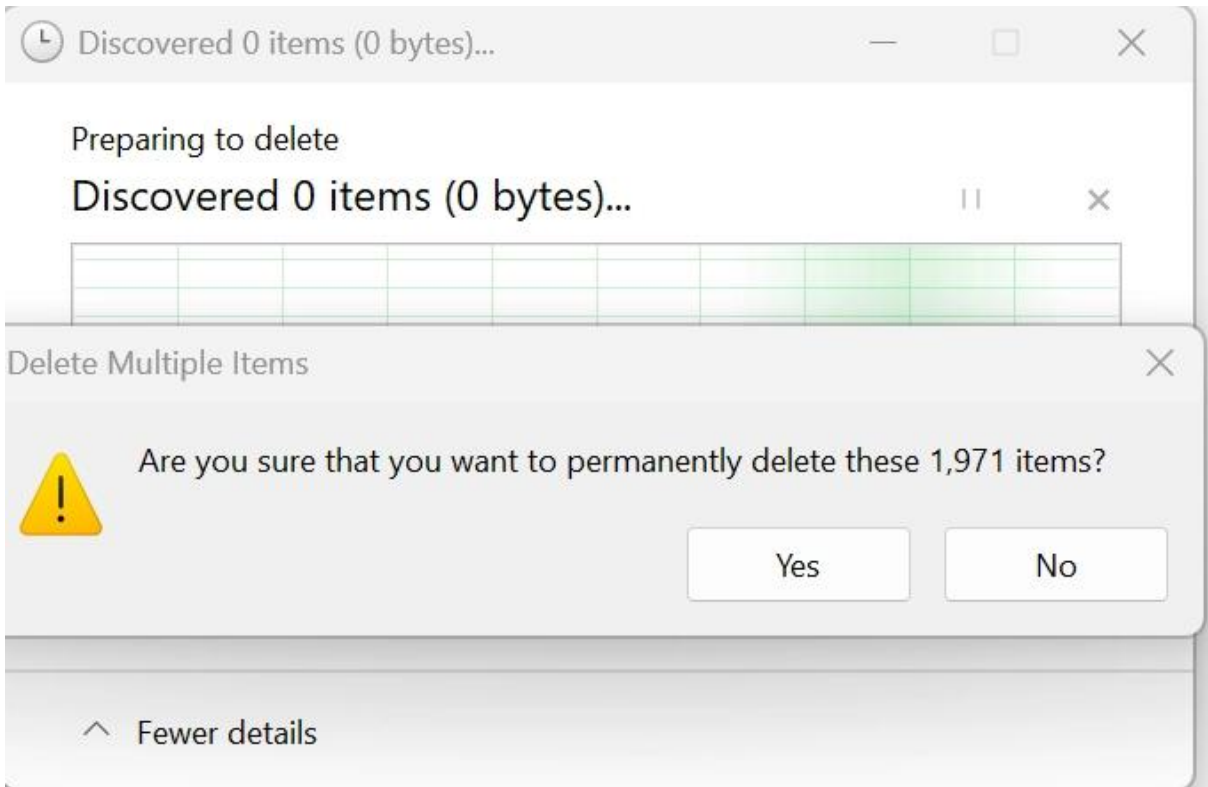
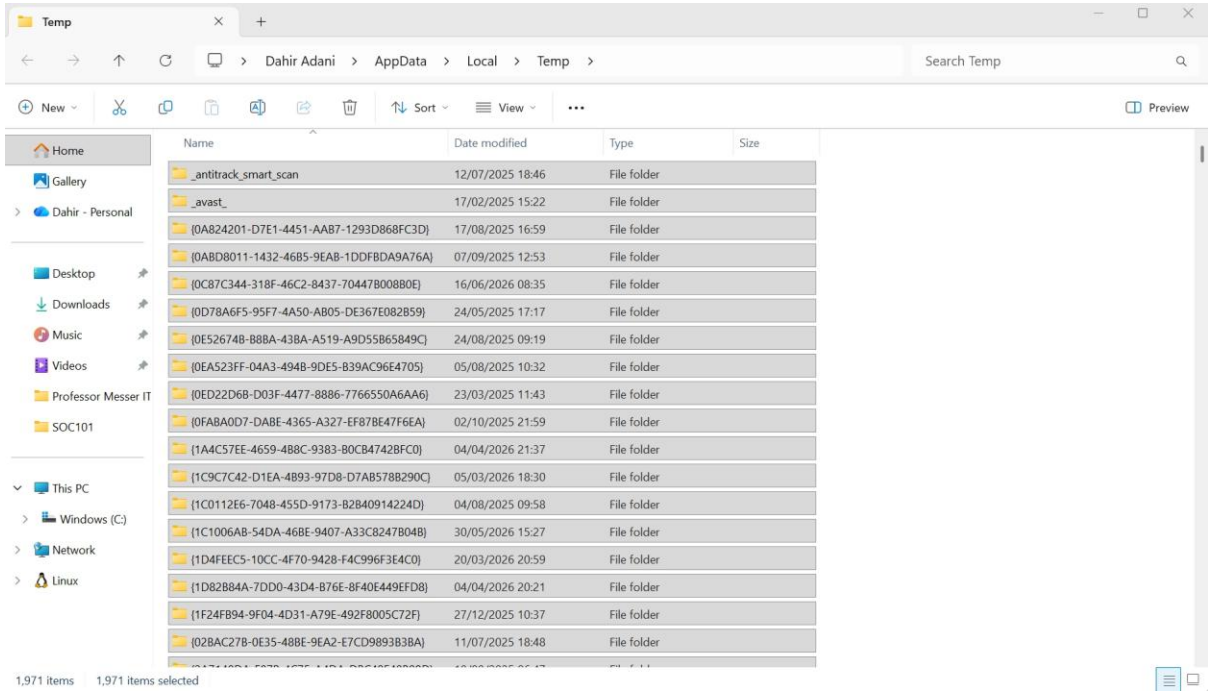
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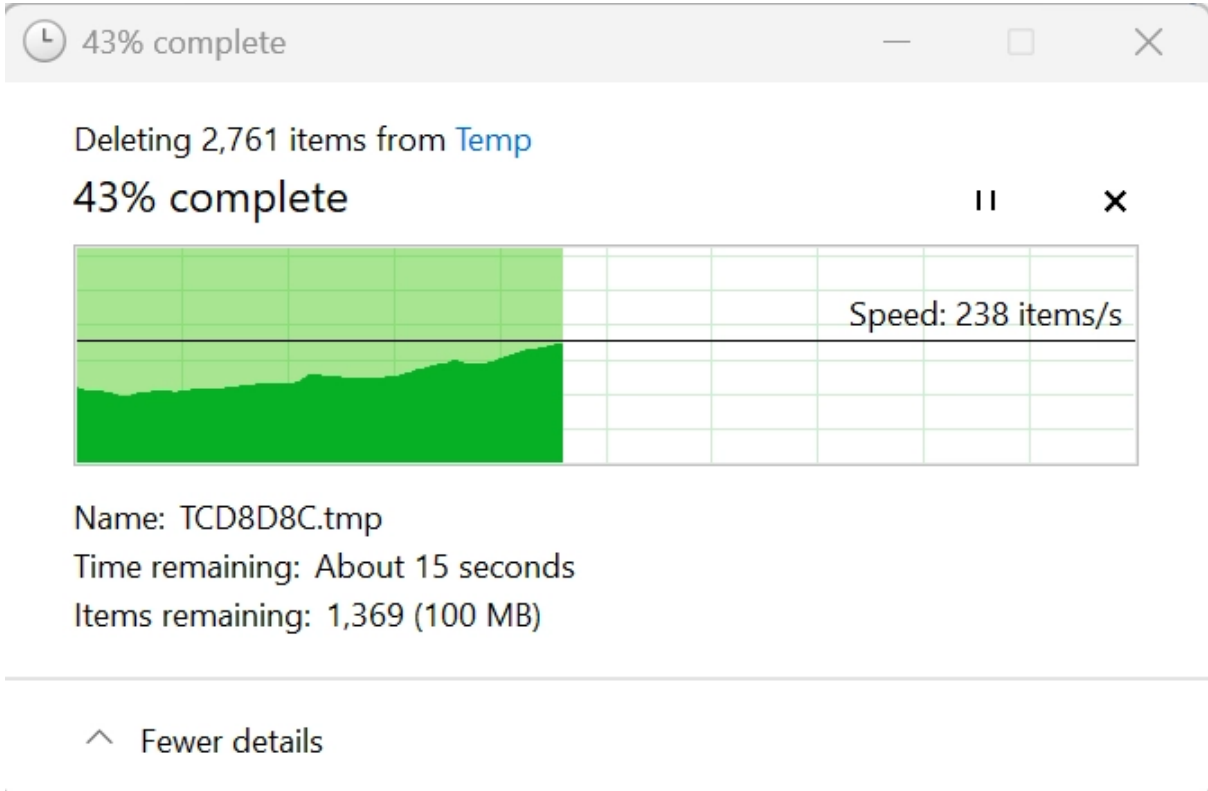
Deleting 2,761 items from Temp  
43% complete



Speed: 238 items/s

Name: TCD8D8C.tmp  
Time remaining: About 15 seconds  
Items remaining: 1,369 (100 MB)

^ Fewer details





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 Run ✕

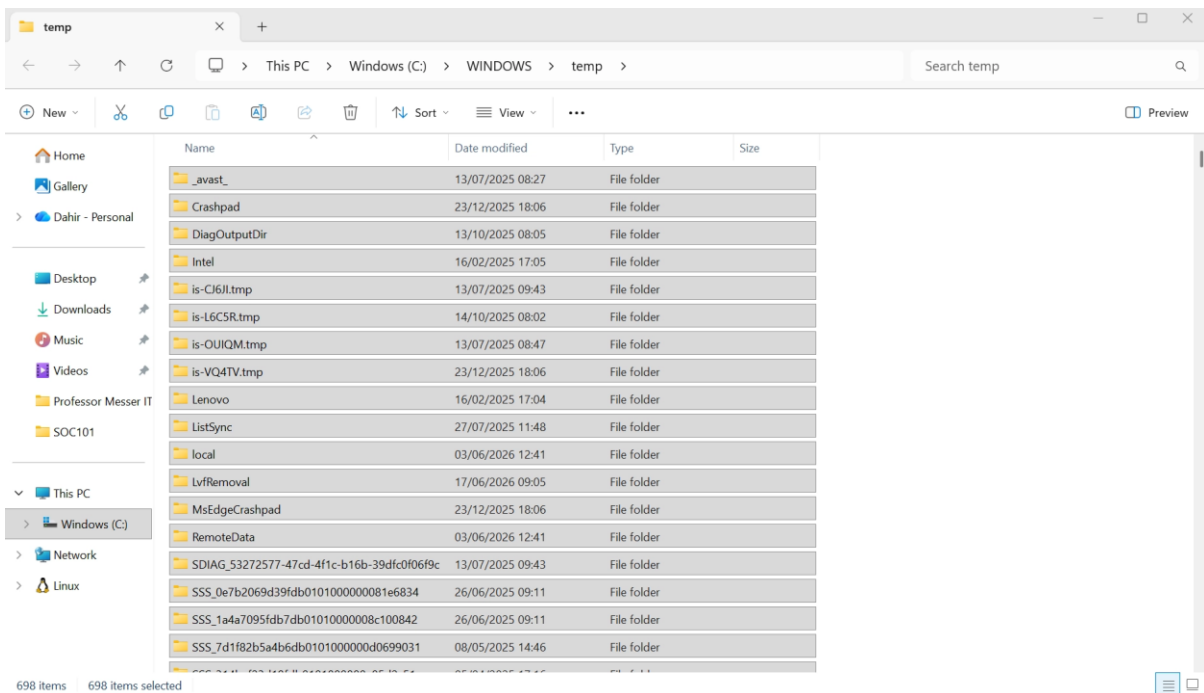
 Type the name of a program, folder, document or Internet resource, and Windows will open it for you.

Open:

OK

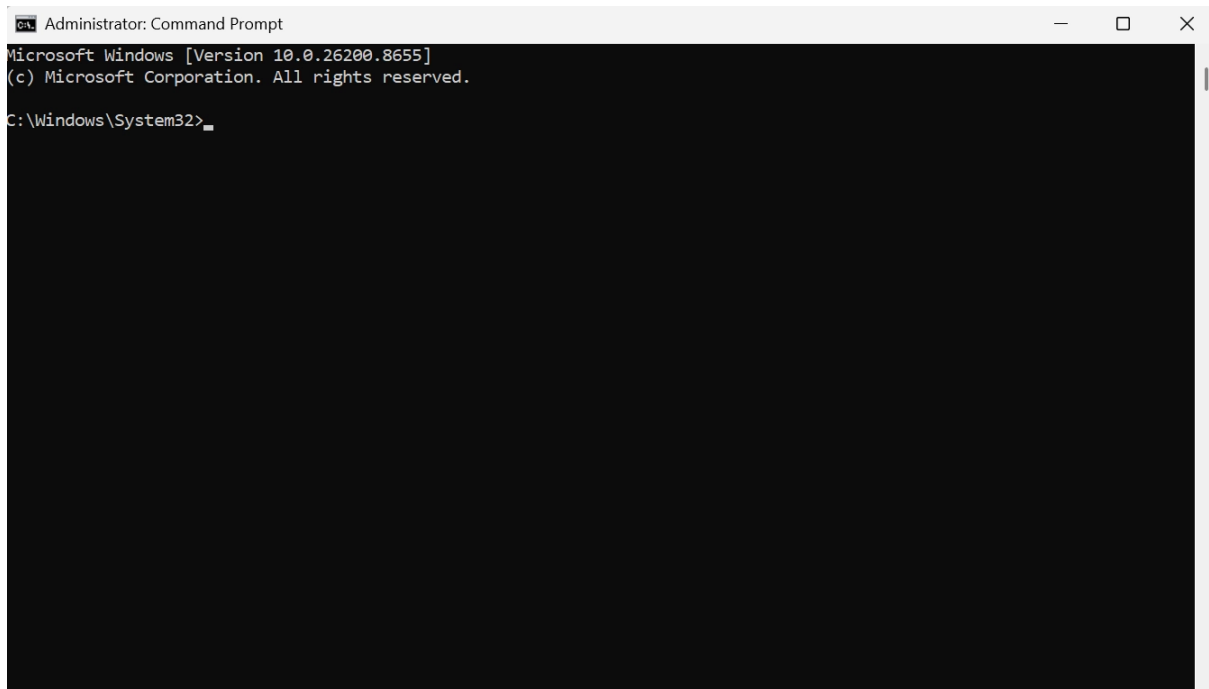
Cancel

Browse...



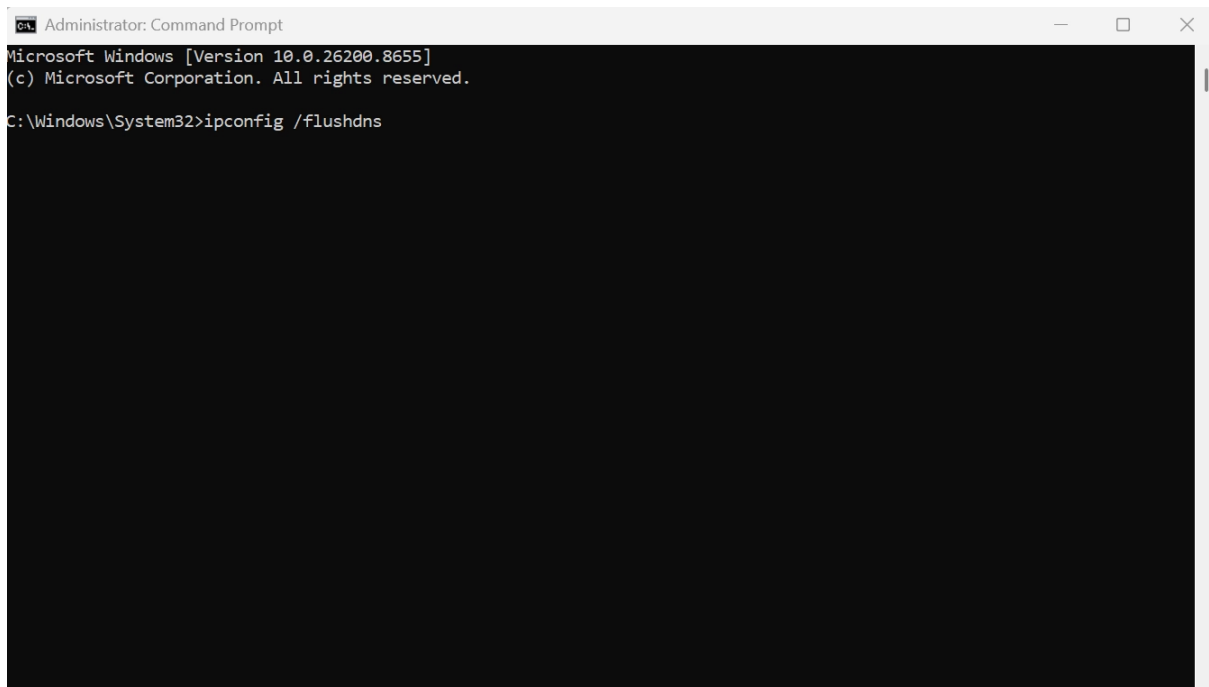
| Name                                       | Date modified    | Type        | Size |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------|------|
| ._avast_                                   | 13/07/2025 08:27 | File folder |      |
| Crashpad                                   | 23/12/2025 18:06 | File folder |      |
| DiagOutputDir                              | 13/10/2025 08:05 | File folder |      |
| Intel                                      | 16/02/2025 17:05 | File folder |      |
| is-CI6Jl.tmp                               | 13/07/2025 09:43 | File folder |      |
| is-L6CSR.tmp                               | 14/10/2025 08:02 | File folder |      |
| is-OUIQM.tmp                               | 13/07/2025 08:47 | File folder |      |
| is-VQ4TV.tmp                               | 23/12/2025 18:06 | File folder |      |
| Lenovo                                     | 16/02/2025 17:04 | File folder |      |
| ListSync                                   | 27/07/2025 11:48 | File folder |      |
| local                                      | 03/06/2026 12:41 | File folder |      |
| LvfRemoval                                 | 17/06/2026 09:05 | File folder |      |
| MsEdgeCrashpad                             | 23/12/2025 18:06 | File folder |      |
| RemoteData                                 | 03/06/2026 12:41 | File folder |      |
| SDIAG_53272577-47cd-4f1c-b16b-39dfc0f06f9c | 13/07/2025 09:43 | File folder |      |
| SSS_0e7b2069d39fdb010100000081e6834        | 26/06/2025 09:11 | File folder |      |
| SSS_1a4a7095fdb7db01010000008c100842       | 26/06/2025 09:11 | File folder |      |
| SSS_7d1f82b5a4b6db0101000000d0699031       | 08/05/2025 14:46 | File folder |      |

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```
Administrator: Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26200.8655]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

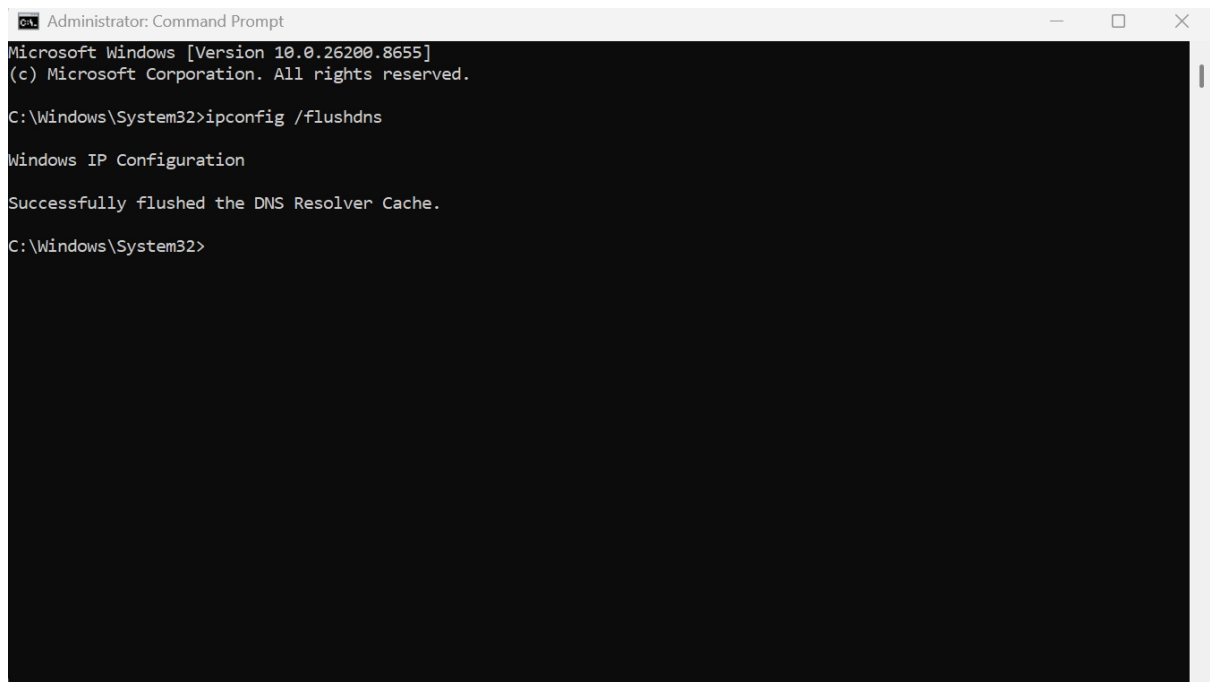
C:\Windows\System32>
```



```
Administrator: Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26200.8655]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Windows\System32>ipconfig /flushdns
```

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```
Administrator: Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26200.8655]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Windows\System32>ipconfig /flushdns

Windows IP Configuration

Successfully flushed the DNS Resolver Cache.

C:\Windows\System32>
```